THE BUDGET GAME.

A new phone repair stall in your city or town. The owner has 3,000 units of money to start. Not one unit more: no loan, no investor. The owner's wish list adds up to 6,000.

NAMES _____ GROUP _____

THE WISH LIST TASKS 1 AND 2 · 17 MINUTES

Task 1: mark each line F (fixed: paid whether you sell or not, such as rent) or V (variable: rises with each sale, such as materials). **Task 2:** keep it, cut it, or make it cheaper, and write the new number. For every cut, ask: will the customer notice? Write Y or N. The new total must be 3,000 or less.

	WHAT THE OWNER WANTS	UNITS	F OR V	KEEP, CUT, CHEAPER	NEW UNITS	NOTICE? Y OR N
A	Repair tools and a screen-fixing kit, the best you can buy	1,200				
B	Spare screens and batteries for the most common phones	900				
C	Rent for the stall space, first month	600				
D	Advertising on local radio for one month	1,000				
E	A painted sign and a printed banner	500				
F	Matching shirts with the stall's name	300				
G	A glass display case	700				
H	A free screen protector with every repair	300				
I	Chairs and a cover for waiting customers	500				
	TOTAL	6,000				

TASK 3 · SPEND BIG ON ONE THING 8 MINUTES

Choose the one line worth real money: where the customer feels it most. Put more into it if you can, using the money from your cuts.

WE SPEND BIG ON LINE _____

THE CUSTOMER WILL FEEL IT BECAUSE _____

TASK 4 · PAY IT BACK 5 MINUTES

After the parts, each repair leaves the stall 30 units of money. The tools (line A) cost 1,200 units. How many repairs pay for the tools? If the stall does four repairs a day, how many days is that?

REPAIRS _____ DAYS _____

YOUR TEAM.

PROBLEM MAP BOX 5 ASSUMPTION TO TEST · FIRST DRAFT · 30 MINUTES

The one thing that must be true for a solution to work, and how to test it cheaply. Start from boxes 1, 2 and 3 and your team asset list from Session 7.

Step 1 · 8 minutes. Every belief your idea depends on:

Step 2 · 7 minutes. Circle the one that must be true. If it is false, nothing else matters.

Step 3 · 10 minutes. A test you can run by hand this week, with what your team already has. No website, no app, no loan.

WE BELIEVE	
WE TEST IT BY	
WE SPEND NO MORE THAN	
WE WILL KNOW BY	

THE PRICE YOU BROUGHT, AND WHAT IT IS FOR

Can your test cost less than that price? How?

Chaos log · 5 minutes: what did your team not know today? A failure you understand, or chaos you do not? What will you do?

FOR YOUR FINAL PROJECT

WHAT IS THE SMALLEST FIRST STEP YOU CAN AFFORD?

Your final presentation must answer this. Start now: write the one thing your team would spend big on, and the cheap test that shows it is worth it.

BEFORE SESSION 09

1. Run your team's cheapest test this week, by hand, outside class. Spend no more than your test allows.
2. Map keeper: write what happened in box 5, in one line.
3. Chaos-log keeper: add one new entry to your team's chaos log.

References (APA 7)

Sternberg, M. (2026). *Hunger, curiosity & chaos: 101 ways entrepreneurs think*. Son of a Botanist Productions. https://starvechaos.com

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